



THE SINISTER WAY

ORDER OF NINE ANGLES

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CUM SUPERIORUM PRIVILEGIO VENIAQUE.

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DEDICATIO

*Pro Deis Sinistris
Et Maioribus Traditionis Nostri*



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PREFACE

The Sinister Way, originally was short for the Sinister Sevenfold Way, which is the name of the Initiatic system by which anyone who resonates with the ONA may gradually initiate themselves into ONA. But over the several decades the term “The Sinister Way” has become synonymous with the whole ONA Way and its Dark Tradition. I personally prefer the term “The Sinister Way” over “Traditional Satanism” because ONA is far more than just Satanism. Although its Satanism is one of the oldest schools of Satanism.

The Sinister Way is the personal path of the Sinister Initiate. It is a path of personal striving to become more than you are. A path of inner alchemy. But it is also a Way, Tao. As in a Way of Life, an Art & Way of doing things. The whole corpus of ONA, is to this Way but guidelines or a Way pointer. Thinking different and seeing the world differently than the Mundane mass does not make us different than them.

It is the Ethos, characteristic, cultural habit, or physis which makes sets two people apart. The word “Sinister” essentially means “Left Side,” or the opposite/adversarial side of what the Mundanes have established as being Right and acceptable. The Sinister Way is a Way of Life which is opposite to how the Mundanes live their lives. It is a Way which contradicts their Mundane ethos. It is not just adverse to how the live and do things. As a Sinister Initiate, there must be a striving within to be in Life and deed, creed, ethos, and physis the opposite of the Mundane.

However they live, live the opposite. However they do, do the opposite. Simply thinking and seeing the world different then the Mundane mass, does not set you apart from them in Way of Life, in Culture, Custom, Habit, and so on. This is one simple explanation of the essence of The Sinister Way: To transcend the Mundane mass, not in words, opinions, or views; but in Way of Life, Ethos, Culture, and Physis. This is the essence of The Sinister Way.

During the Chaos of this Kali Yuga, the Sinister [vama] Way [marga] is the most expedient Way to achieving Enlightenment. And it is the only Way to pay due homage to the Dark Goddess – archetype of this yuga –

represented in our Dark Tradition as Baphomet, Mistress of Blood. Thus, The Sinister Way is the Way of Kali Yuga.

Thus the Sinister Way does indeed go far beyond Satanism. For we are no longer speaking of adhering to an ideology, an -ism, to a set of Satanic principles or Satanic views, to some Satanic philosophy. We are dealing with a Celestial Season we are currently in: the essence of which is Chaos and Disorder. We have the choice of being like the Mundanes and going against the Flow of the current yuga in ignorance, or we go with the Flow of Chaos. If, as Sinister Initiates, we choose the latter; then the Sinister Way is a vehicle thru which the essence of this Kali yuga manifest into the causal world; and each of us Sinister Initiates are thus living nexions of Chaos.

Chloe 352

Order of Nine Angles, 124 Year of Feyen

INTRODUCTION

For the last four decades, the Order of Nine Angles has offered its initiates a traditional system of occult and sinister training that is designed to create Adepts. This system, if correctly followed, brings the initiate into contact with acausal energies and entities that are outside the realm of mundane experience. This is not an easy process, and it is clearly not for the faint of heart. Further, as Anton Long has written, the ONA is not the only system that leads to a certain esoteric wisdom, but it *is* one of the very few ways that leads to that wisdom in a reduced time frame, allowing for significant spiritual progress in months instead of years, and years rather than decades.

The tools with which one can undertake this journey are well-documented in such manuscripts as *Naos* and the *Black Book of Satan*, and clarified through *Hostia*. For example, one must be willing to undergo rigorous physical challenges, to learn musical chant, to obtain a special crystal tetrahedron, and to perform rites of pathworking with the sinister tarot. Yet pathworking doesn't get talked about as much as one might expect. Perhaps this is because at the end of the day, not many people want to admit to actually doing the chanting, the sketching, the visualization, and the holding to a belief that there really *are* sinister acausal beings that the Adept needs to deal with in order to advance. But it is clear from the sinister fiction of the ONA and from the writings of the 'Old Guard' that indeed the Dark Gods are not merely abstracts, but actual beings that must be sought and communed with in order to gain the acausal essence that is needed for mastery. Pathworking with the sinister tarot, then, is not simply a part of the tradition that can be put aside, but rather is a core part of the mythos and practice of the ONA.

This volume, *The Sinister Way*, presents several of the texts related to pathworking and sinister esotericism from the *Hostia* volumes, and adds to it the entire Sinister Tarot of ONA's Christos Beest. As with every text in this authorized series, nothing here cannot be downloaded for free – but for many, it is easier and more efficient to engage with these texts in a printed and bound fashion. This holds doubly true for the incredible

sinister artwork of Beest, and it is the editor's hope that through this volume, those who do not own a hardcopy set of the Sinister Tarot will now have access to it, and by it to better pursue the Sinister Way itself.

Chrétien Sauvage

ONA, 124 yf.

PART ONE



THE TRADITION OF THE SINISTER WAY

The essence of genuine Satanism can be simply stated: it is a way to inner development, the goal of which is a new individual. This way involves three essential stages and these exemplify the spirit of that way and the individuals who follow it.

The first is direct experience, the second is direct practice and the third self-development. The first involves direct experience of both the external 'world' and the inner (or psychic) 'world' through striving to achieve certain goals both practical and magickal. The second involves using 'practical' (or causal) and 'magickal' (or acausal) energies to manipulate others, situations and energies in a practical way – producing changes in accord with certain goals. The third involves beginning the process again but starting from the new level of self-understanding and ability attained – pursuing different {and probably more complex} goals.

A Satanist is an individual explorer – following in the footsteps of others (and perhaps using their guide books) but always seeking further horizons, daring to defy convention (in ideas as well as in morals and attitude) yet part of an evolutionary succession enabling what is experienced to be understood and become beneficial. For this reason, a genuine Satanist understands tradition as important and necessary – the culmination of centuries of insight and experience, a useful guide which enables further progress and exploration: a starting point for that inner and outer journey which is begun by Initiation, as well as a map of the way chosen and followed.

This tradition is not sacrosanct – but it does possess a validity until the individual reaches the stage where the unique genius within each individual has been brought to fruition enabling the creation (from experience and self-insight) of a unique way and a fulfilling of a unique Destiny. In magickal terms, this is the stage of Internal Adept, where that unique Destiny is made known (discovered) and where the individual Initiate has developed the talents necessary to fulfill it by a following of the previous stages – a stage reached from between three to five years after Initiation.

The tradition (explicated in the ‘seven–fold sinister way’) provides only a beginning – it is for the individual to go beyond it, toward the dangers and rewards of the Abyss. It is, however, necessary – since it is, in one sense, a ‘short–cut’: enabling self-development to be achieved far quicker than would be the case without it as well as fully enabling the explication of individual potential.

This does not mean that following it is easy – the path may be shorter, but it is just as dangerous (and in some places, more so). It is a mountain path to the summit rather than a meandering valley path, and enables the horizon, the other mountains waiting to be conquered, to be seen –as they cannot be seen from the wooded valleys below.

But each new Initiate must walk this path – alone. And for each it is a new experience, a process of direct learning and a personal achievement, for only a very few have ever ventured that way before and stood atop the summit that is ‘Internal Adept’ to see in the distance the still higher peaks that wait beyond the Abyss.

What is important is following that path –and going beyond it, toward the Abyss – actually undertaking the journey and experiencing in real time what is encountered and seen: of being taken to the very limits of your endurance and abilities. No one can do this for you – just as the path does not lead to some pleasant grove where you sit at the feet of some ‘Master’ listening to their past experiences and fables. It does not involve you staying comfortably ‘at home’ with the security of your known world and friends and ideas, just as it is not a ‘mental’ journey done in comfortable surroundings and with no physical effort or danger. It *is* practical, and direct – and involves physical and psychic hardship, and while you may be a little soft when you start, you will not be so when you succeed, Just as if you believe you are tough enough now, you will be rudely awakened.

Is this what you really want?

O.N.A.

SINISTER SHADOW MAGICK

Satanism is dark, and Satanists revel in evil. As a word, evil is regarded as deriving from the Gothic (via Old English) ‘ubils’ implying ‘beyond’ and ‘going beyond due limits’. Later, the word – like so many others – was re- interpreted ‘morally’, in the abstract terms of Nazarene fundamentalism and ‘evil’ became a general term, applied to one’s opponents and those excesses which timid and psychically ailing Nazarenes feared.

Genuine Satanists do evil, they cultivate evil: they are evil, in all senses of the term now accepted. Imitation Satanists, however, play mental and intellectual games: they enjoy the ‘thrill’ of calling themselves Satanists. Some go further, and may revel in a local notoriety, finding a vicarious pleasure in being known as a ‘Satanist’. But these imposters do no evil – in fact, they explain (quite often) that Satanism has been misunderstood and is really rather a ‘moral religion’ (or something of the kind), perhaps even an ‘ethical knowledge’. Such people are pathetic and certainly not Satanists. In the beginning, a genuine Satanist will cultivate evil on the personal level – by going to and thus finding his or her limits. This involves more than just going beyond the (accepted) limits imposed by society or whatever. It means experience, on the practical level, of evil and all that it implies. Later, when the Satanic novice has some experience and thus self- understanding and mastery, there is impersonal evil. The first is sinister shadow magick of the external and internal kind. The second is sinister shadow magick of the aeonic type – the manipulation, changing, of individuals and events on a not insignificant scale, that is, one which produces tangible results and often disruption/creation/evolution and thus continues the sinister dialectic of history. This is called ‘shadow magick’ not only because it is mostly secretly done, but also because it is dangerous, psychically and physically, involving as it does acts of defiance against the restrictions imposed by all other forms and individuals.

Neither of these means a type of juvenile ‘rebellion’ nor purely ‘mental’ acts (achieved by ritual or anything else). They mean a directed,

calculating, purposeful involvement in real life and situations: for the beginner Satanist (the novice) just as much as the Adept. What differs, is the aim at first, it is personal, to aid self-mastery, understanding and thus build Satanic character; then, it is impersonal or aeonic. Thus one image of the genuine Satanist – someone in control, seeking more mastery of life; seeking more challenges and goals and insights.

Let me be explicit so I cannot be misunderstood.

1) The Satanic novice will aspire – to what is beyond, in all things. This means practical experience, testing Destiny and achieving difficult goals in the personal life. It means real danger in the real world, not cheap manufactured ‘thrills’ of self-induced stupor and loss of control – but rather, life and liberty threatening situations. These may be and often are amoral, illegal and evil – all laws are ‘fundamentally an accumulation of tireless attempts to stop creative individuals making life into instants of poetry’.

Naturally, some guidance may be needed – it is easy to become lost, directionless, or caught – and this is where the advice of a more experienced Satanic Adept may be useful. However, the acts of a Satanist are not random nor motiveless and neither do they arise from any weakness of character nor uncontrolled desire. Instead, they arise from fulfilling Satanic wyrd – to or, viewed another way, from presencing the energies of ‘darkness’/Satan on the Earth in accord with sinister intent.

An example will explicate this. A Satanic novice, having developed to a certain extent via ordeals such as Grade Rituals, the achievement of personal, physical goals and the organizing and running of a Satanic Temple, desires to go further. For this, practical experience and some guidance is needed. Let us assume the novice is advised or chooses to use a political form to achieve this experience – and thus becomes involved with radical ‘right-wing’ politics because such people already possess an element or two of Satanic spirit, the ‘other sides’ in this form and at this moment in the history of this aeon representing the Nazarene disease in another guise. Thus, she takes part in direct political actions – this is both

exciting and dangerous, given the prevailing sickness of this age. Gradually, she acquires practical experience ‘on the edge’, and hopefully some real, tangible enemies, if she is performing right. These enemies probably hate her for her political views – and some of them may even try to harm her personally.

Thus, one or more of them deserve to die – or at least come to some harm, psychically if not physically. For they not only threaten her own Destiny and thus achievement, but also Satanic wyrd, because she by her actions is fulfilling higher, Satanic goals (in simple terms, presencing the darker forces via a tangible form). This fulfilling is expressed in the form she is guided toward or chooses for herself via a knowledge of Aeonics.

On the practical level, she can and should undertake magickal rites (such as the Death Ritual) to aid her – but other means can be used, such as assassination. She may wish to do this herself, or she may manipulate others into doing it.

The result is the same – personal experience and development, and aeonic energies presenced via the execution of the act. Thus is her own evolution, and that of the acausal or sinister, furthered.

Given the nature of the form chosen, this Satanic novice, by using such a form to the utmost of her ability (that is, seeing it as fulfilling a part of her own Destiny – conventionally, ‘believing in the correctness of the views so espoused’) goes beyond the norms of society and its herd majority and thus achieves personal knowledge of the illegal and the forbidden (in that society).

2) Beyond this, when Adeptship is attained by experiences such as the foregoing, the Satanist will try and open a nexion – to directly access acausal energies on Earth via rites such as Nine Angles etc. This is the beginning of aeonic shadow magick – and this involves an even greater commitment to change than before, on the practical level. What form or forms this takes depends on individual wyrd, discovered by the Grade Ritual of Internal Adept and prepared for by previous rites, and experiences. It may be political, as it may be the use/manipulation of archetypal forms/ images with sinister intent – or involve using ‘religion’ as a Satanic instrument of change. Whatever the form, the changes are

supra-personal they effect more than a few individuals. In fact, they radically disrupt existing forms and norms. For example, a political form may be chosen and used. After some time, violence, riots somewhere, the spread of a new idea ... The rising of a type of State in essence inspired with sinister energies and thus contributing to aeonic evolution ... Perhaps a war to propitiate with blood the darker forces.

Thus, it will be understood that Satanists act in a directed way, whether they are novices, or Adepts. Their evil has a purpose [as Satan Himself does as do THEY who are beyond Him have a purpose. on this Earth]. The acts and the evil arise from a Satanic desire and understanding made real in a practical form or forms. The going beyond, the evil, are part of Satanic wyrd – on the personal and aeonic level.

I repeat – they are not directionless, motiveless acts, nor do they arise because the person doing them is somehow inadequate or weak or in the thrall of some uncontrolled desire! The Satanist is controlled – knowledgeable, particularly about themselves and what Satanism means in supra-personal terms. They are part of history –participants in a sinister dialectic of supra-aeonic proportions, and aware of the power of the sinister to change both themselves and those forms which others through the ages have created to shape our evolution or which [like the Nazarene disease] hinder our evolution. Have I been understood? Does this sound the death-bell for the imitation Satanists? (γνωση τεκνησ σημεια της εμης κλυων). It is a pity that this, like Satanism, is so often misunderstood and mistranslated.

ACAUSAL EXISTENCE –THE SECRET REVEALED

Acausal existence – the secret of true Immortality – has been hinted at many times in certain esoteric writings connected with a particular LHP.

In the past, a few Adepts of the LHP – and the occasional notorious individual interested in dark sorcery – tried to secure for themselves an acausal existence by dark rites of sacrifice, and as a result dark legends arose. But such means are not really necessary.

Before describing what is necessary, a brief examination of such acausal existence will be in order. According to a sinister tradition we as individuals possessed of consciousness have both a causal and an acausal aspect to that consciousness. The acausal is latent (or mostly so) and magickal Initiation awakens it – opening a gate or nexion to the acausal. This allows the acausal to be apprehended (usually via a symbolism such as the septenary Tree of Wyrd) and acausal energies to be used/directed (i.e. ‘magick’). The result is an ‘expansion’ of consciousness. Progression by the Initiate to the higher grades of initiation is actually the expansion of the acausal in individual consciousness (or, viewed another way, the progression of the individual into the acausal) – a balance of causal/acausal being achieved in ‘the Abyss’. Beyond this, because of the balance so attained, it is possible to transcend to the acausal – to create an acausal existence when the causal ceases (i.e. physical death).

The acausal is not however, a ‘dreamy realm’ or some kind of nirvana/heaven. It is rather, the very essence of Being – beyond opposites, primal Chaos. Nirvana and such like are abstract moral forms – i.e. they are ‘unbalanced’ since they lack darkness, the sinister, the negative [Nirvana and such like are usually described in terms only of ‘light’.] The acausal is the realm of the Dark Gods – and these beings are not imaginative symbols ‘for the titillation of consciousness, nor simply a part of the psyche, to be transcended or negated or whatever by ‘forces of light’. Rather, they exist independent of our consciousness [yet such is the nature of the acausal that they are also part of what is dormant within us] and while they may be accessed (or ‘dis-covered’) by consciousness and thus presenced in the causal (on Earth) their actual intrusion would

totally disrupt sentient life in the causal – like the meeting of matter and anti-matter. Sinister magick (of the aeonic and internal kind) may be said to be like a machine or engine where containment of opposites is possible and controllable in certain amounts and under certain conditions.

[In simple terms, sinister aeonic magick contains the flow of the acausal into a temporal form – usually an Aeon and its associated civilization – via a nexion/magickal center to thus over thousands of years increase the amount of the acausal that is presenced, increasing thus evolution in individuals in accordance with sinister goals. Such is one of the forms of real Black Magick.]

The nature of acausal existence may be apprehended by individuals by certain sinister rites such as those of the Nine Angles. To achieve an individual acausal existence the sinister path must be followed, from Initiate to Internal Adept to Master/Mistress and beyond because this following of such a path in the way indicated (qv. *Naos* and *Black Book*) creates acausal consciousness in the individual over causal time. The Grade Ritual of Grand Master/G. Mistress makes the Adept more acausal than causal. Beyond this, is a simple ritual (the solo Nine Angles rite done by the Grand Master/G. Mistress) when consciousness is transferred beyond the nexion opened/created by the previous Grade Ritual. Immortality – the final stage of the way – is then achieved, followed then or shortly thereafter by causal death, although consciousness can be transferred to inhabit another causal body, this is not usually done as wyrd is achieved. Simple, really, this alchemical process takes about 25 years. By virtue of the nexion, the new Immortal alters the temporal structure of the world, usually for an Aeon.

Now the secret has been revealed, the possibility is open to all. But it is doubtful if more than one or two a century will try, such is human weakness.

ONA (1991eh)

THE ABYSS

The Abyss is where the causal and the acausal meet: a nexus of temporal and spatial dimensions. Because of the nature of our consciousness, the Abyss lies latent within all of us –that is, our consciousness consists of both causal and acausal aspects. In this sense, we are all ‘Gates’/ acausal dimensions, although this Gate – and the pathways leading to/from it – often lies undiscovered. Magickal training is essentially the discovery, exploration and use of these pathways.

Symbolized causally, the Abyss lies between the spheres of the Sun and Mars in the septenary Tree of Wyrð, and the ‘Entering the Abyss’ is that stage of magickal development which distinguishes the Master/ Mistress from the Adept. The experience of the Abyss –which the Grade Ritual ‘Entering the Abyss’ begins – is fundamentally a destruction of the self– image which the Grade Ritual of Internal Adept created and which was glimpsed during the External Adept rite. It is also the destruction of all personal illusions regarding opposites: the final ‘withdrawing of projections’. In essence, the Internal Adept has learnt (mainly through the Grade Ritual) to withdraw the projections of the ‘ego’ from other individuals –that is, theirs is an understanding of individuals as those individuals are in essence: without the distortion of one’s own passions/ideas/prejudices and without the distortions of other people’s ideas/judgments and so on. The experience of the Abyss takes this a stage further – there is a withdrawal of all personal projections made by every individual upon others/the ‘cosmos’ and so on: both personal and impersonal. Thus, the essence is apprehended behind the appearance which the causal produces because it is the causal. Put very simply, the Abyss is the beginning of acausal perception. This perception implies a complete understanding of oneself, one’s wyrð, as well as an understanding of others, of aeonic influences, and of the ‘cosmos’ itself – the beginnings of wisdom.

Yet this does not mean a negation of individuality. Rather, it is an enhancement of consciousness. This is so because the Abyss is also the Tree of Wyrð itself – all the spheres and the pathways in both their

individual and aeonic forms: the ‘individual forms’ being Jungian-type archetypes (and the experiences/ understanding appropriate to these) on a personal level, and the ‘aeonic forms’ being aeonic/cultural myths and images on a supra-personal level, in both ‘sinister’ and ‘light’ aspects. Further, the Abyss is also a direct opening or ‘Gate’ to the acausal dimensions.

The ritual of the Abyss implies an acceptance of acausal energies as those energies are—that is, without any ‘abstract’, personal or judgmental views. It is a letting ‘in’ of those Null, Chaotic energies without any hindrance. This of course can be dangerous, but the preparation reduces this danger as well as making possible an understanding of those energies and the ‘forms’ they may or may not assume in both the causal and acausal worlds. This latter point is quite important, because there have been many who, unprepared, having experienced some acausal energies via entering the Abyss too soon. Quite often, the result of this premature magickal experience is madness or extreme personal dis-orientation resulting in a ‘possessed’ personal life and/or loss of vitality; another and frequent result is personal delusion about one’s own abilities and understanding, both personal and magickal.

This understanding of the acausal, vital to a ‘successful’ crossing of the Abyss, derives from the preparation implicit in (a) having undertaken the Grade Ritual of Internal Adept [that is, in essence, having spent at least three months alone without any external influences and without any personal contact] and (b) having fulfilled the tasks revealed by that Grade Ritual. This fulfilling of personal tasks (the accomplishment is of part of the wyrd of the individual) is necessary (and it takes from one to many years after the Grade Ritual of Internal Adept) because it dissipates the energy of the ‘self-image’ that the Grade Ritual produces, preparing thus a voidness within the Adept. The Adept generally knows when this inner void is reached (in simple terms, the personal, driving energy is gone through achievement of personal goals: the reality, of course, is more complicated and here the advice of a Master/Mistress/Magus is often sought).

The ritual of the Abyss is simple. The physical part (the walk in the specified time without assistance) is essential preparation for the ‘magickal’ part because it prepares the consciousness in a very specific way as well as draining the physical resources of the body. To complete the walk given the conditions stated requires determination – and this determination is released/abandoned when the magickal part of the rite is begun, this release/abandonment occurring quite naturally because the physical goal has been achieved. Thus, there is a ‘hidden’ wisdom in the construction of the rite (as there is in all the Grade Rituals).

The physical part also creates – because of the isolation – a feeling within the individual of being only a part of something more vast, and it for this reason that the walk is undertaken as far from human habitation as possible.

This isolation, the concentration required to walk at a pace –enabling the goal to be reached within the set time, the rhythm of walking, the anticipation of the magickal part, all combine to produce] the conditions necessary within the consciousness of the individual conducive to success.

As mentioned above, the Abyss is also an opening into the acausal. The ‘passing of the Abyss’ is the opening of that ‘Gate’ within us. All magick is a glimpse of the acausal. and the stages of the seven–fold way are really stages when the acausal energies are developed and understood in a progressively more emphatic manner – that is, they may be seen as ‘pushing that Gate wider and wider’ – in the passing of the Abyss there is no longer a Gate, but rather a union or fusion. In another sense, the seven–fold way may be said to be the creation within the consciousness of the individual, of connections or pathways to the acausal – each stage develops more and more pathways until they form a conduit through which acausal energy ‘flows’. Beyond the Abyss, the individual is part of the acausal ‘flow’ and has achieved the goal of sentient life. This is really the great secret of alchemy, of magick and of the Left Hand or Sinister Path itself – that is, we can create for ourselves another existence in another ‘universe’ and an existence which continues after our causal self dies. The means to this existence is simply – the seven fold way.

According to tradition, the Abyss is also presented physically in our causal universe. That is, terrestrial and ‘Space’ or ‘Star’ Gates exist where the two universes are joined. In reality, the terrestrial Gates may be said to be points where the causal and acausal come close to contact: where there is ‘seepage’ of acausal energy –the discovery of these places If and then the ‘opening of the Gate’ via magick producing Aeonic energy to alter the causal (and thus the individuals in the world). [See the Order MSS relating to Aeons, ‘Lovecraft and the Dark Gods’ etc.]

ESOTERIC TRADITION – SYNISTRY

Dark Gods: These are ‘living’ entities which exist in an acausal space–time. They may be likened to ‘anti-matter’ as against the ‘matter’ which exists in our causal space-time – thus, their intrusion into the causal, disrupts. This disruption is primarily psychic because the psyche of an individual by its nature intrudes or is a part of the acausal. The entities can assume physical forms, but only briefly – and then only when a nexion is fully opened. And where the causal and acausal intersect on Earth. The Dark Gods do not have ‘forms’ as understood causally – because a physical form is a causal thing, and they are beyond the causal. Neither do they possess ‘feelings’ etc. as we understand the terms. They are on the edge of even an Adept’s comprehension [in terms of understanding Them]. They can act [i.e. have effects in the causal] via individuals who can access them – or ‘presence’ them. It should be understood that the Dark Gods are not ‘the acausal’ itself. They exist in a part (or one realm) of the acausal – that is, – they exist, have life or being according to the nature of the acausal.

The acausal is ‘beyond causal time’ and does not have a spatial 3D-geometry. Other beings probably exist in other acausal dimensions – but of them there is no knowledge.

When an Initiate accesses the acausal – increases the acausal aspect of their consciousness – they are extending the range of their being: i.e. evolving, creating new aspects of consciousness. This is one of the aims of the seven-fold Way – and of all real magick. A part of this, may involve confrontation with some of the ‘Dark Gods’. In conventional terms, the Dark Gods are evil, sinister.

The Western Aeon: As far as Adepts of the sinister tradition are concerned, there are only two realistic options: the creation of Imperium [the fulfillment of Western wyrd via a practical form], or disruption of existing forms with the aim of undermining and destroying Nazarene/Magian influence, leading to chaos from which a New Aeon will emerge, this Aeon being Satanic. The latter involves the ‘pruning’ of unnecessary

elements on a large scale –the creation of an elite capable of making the Aeon a reality. The first involves the creation/aiding of a practical form – and presencing magickal energy into it. It also involves creating the right psychic conditions – within and external to individuals.

Some of this is directly magickal, involving magickal energy accessed via rituals etc.; some of it is providing/creating/making available the information and forms of the sinister. The practical form is either directly political, or ‘religious’. Both involve a more widespread dissemination of the sinister tradition and creation of new forms for its energies.

*Such as ‘magickal centres’ associated with an Aeon – or the finding of such places. It is possible to create such a place –and this is one meaning of such rituals as the Ceremony of Recalling with Sacrificial Conclusion. Traditions and New Forms: As mentioned elsewhere, maintaining the tradition (as explicated in such works as *The Black Book of Satan*, *Naos*, *The Deofel Quartet* and *Hostia*) and making it more widely available, is important –and indeed essential. This is because the use of the tradition, in whole or in part [e.g. rituals from the Black Book] by others outside of being drawn into the tradition, makes those others ‘channels’ for the sinister energy the tradition represents. That is, they ‘presence’ sinister energies in a precise and particular way and thus fulfill sinister strategy. The tradition has been given its present form [as explicated in the various books and MSS] to achieve just this (as well as other things).

However, the creation of new forms is important and indeed vital – there must be a continuing evolution. These forms will further access the sinister, and presence it. The tradition itself serves as a Way – oth for individuals, and aeonically: it enables the achievement of individual Adeptship, as well as the fulfillment of the sinister dialectic of history.

This will be so for the next few centuries – until the New Aeon becomes a reality. That is, its methods and techniques should not be changed (at least not intentionally by those of the tradition for the next few decades) or ‘superseded’ – as a way of creating Adepts etc. This is not a question of ‘dogma’ but rather strategy, as mentioned above. It is vital

that this and the reasons for and beyond it are understood by those of the tradition. The external forms [such as arise prior to and during the Aeon] will only arise from an initial coherence of magickal energies and intent – and it is and will be the unchanging form of the ‘Way’ [techniques, rituals etc. which will enable this. The new forms created/evolved will add to rather than undermine what already is. Anything else is simply individuals playing at magick (and particularly playing at Aeonics) without achieving anything and indeed without understanding what they are doing.

Initiation and Beyond: The quest of an individual can only and ever be individual, that is, unique. The quest, made possible and aided by the tradition, develops the individual, enabling individual wyrd to be understood, and lived.

It is also makes possible Immortality (qv. *Acausal Existence –The Secret Revealed*). Beyond a certain level, Initiates guide themselves – to learning from their own real-life experiences. That is, they have acquired sufficient self-insight and honesty to enable them to do this. When this stage is reached [toward the end of External Adept for some; during and beyond Internal Adept for others] there should be still a following of the ultimate goal – a striving for the Abyss and beyond, although this ‘striving’ will be more balanced than hitherto. This does not mean the individuals become or develop their own ways of achieving that goal – that is, not undergoing the Grade Rituals of Internal Adept and beyond according to tradition because they believe they are not necessary or that they have/can create (d) other means. Should they do this, they will not achieve the specific goal of the sinister way – but rather something else entirely, or else nothing. The reasons should be obvious from the above Traditions.

The Aim: Wisdom and its living, enabling the last stage (into the acausal). This means self-understanding and supra-personal understanding. An apprehension of the world and its forms as they are – a rational knowing: and what is necessary for change, aeonic and otherwise. This knowledge is sometimes sad, and often born from ordeals

and having lived the Abyss. It never confers wealth nor privilege, and seldom imbues one with 'happiness'. It is beyond words, but can sometimes be transmuted into a form enabling some others to apprehend it only in part its essence. This aim takes causal time – usually circa 20 years from Initiation (if the Way is followed) – and lies beyond the Abyss. It is balance, beyond opposites, a new way of being.

ESOTERIC TRADITION VI

Baphomet, Opfer and Related Matters: The word ‘opfer’ generally refers to the sacrifice that occurs –symbolic or otherwise during certain rituals. There are, generally, two types of opfer: (1) associated with rites to open a nexion, between Aeons – when such an opfer(s) are considered necessary in terms of the ‘energy’ required; (2) those associated with traditional beliefs regarding the ‘working of the cosmos. (‘Opfers’ associated with ‘death rituals’ form a third type.) The second type, according to tradition, was chosen once every 17 years and this sacrifice was regarded as necessary to retain ‘the cosmic balance’ – in modern terms, keep a nexion open (and thus preserve the associated higher civilization etc.).

The chosen one was made an honorary Priest (this type of opfer was always male – see below) and there was a joining between him and one or more women, as Priestesses. This joining was a simple type of ‘hierosgamos’, and the offspring of the union(s) were given great honour. At the ceremony itself, the head of the opfer was severed and displayed – usually for a night and a day (although this period may have been longer in the very distant past). The rite was conducted outdoors in a ‘Sacred’ place – often a circle of stones or hill–top. The chosen one was able, because of the sacrifice, to partake of an acausal existence – becoming thus an Immortal.

Thus was ‘willing sacrifice’ possible, although it is easy to imagine that in later times, the opfer was not always willing. Traditionally, this type goes back to Albion and while originally the ritual was probably a community affair, it became more and more secretive. What survives to the present day (The Ceremony of Recalling with ‘opfer’ ending) probably reflects the essence of this earlier tradition rather than the detail (the words, chants etc.). This essence may be apprehended in the role of the mistress of Earth – representative of Baphomet, the dark goddess. It was to Baphomet that the sacrifice was made – hence a male opfer. Indeed, the whole ceremony (of Recalling) can be seen as a celebration of the dark goddess – the Earth Mistress/goddess in her darker/ violent/sinister

aspect. The ‘severed head’ was associated with the ‘worship’ of Baphomet – hence the traditional representation of Baphomet.

This ‘cult of Baphomet’ derives from Albion (see below). The significance of the 17 year cycle is unclear – if there was an oral tradition, it has been lost. In the past few decades, some theories to explain this 17 year cycle have been advanced, but they are unconvincing.

The identification of Baphomet as the Bride of Lucifer/Satan probably dates from around the 10th or 11th century (ev), as does the use of the name ‘Satan’/Satanas as the Earth-bound representative of the Dark Gods. It is important to remember that in earlier times (eg. in Albion during the Hyperborean aeon) there was no clear and/or ‘moral’ distinction between the ‘light’ and the ‘sinister’: the two were seen as different aspects of the same thing. Thus, what we know as the Mistress of Earth (the ‘goddess’) was both what we now call ‘Baphomet’ (the dark aspect) and Gaia (the Earth mother). Likewise with the ‘male’ aspect – Satan and Lucifer – or Dionysus/Kabeiroi and Apollo. We now understand all such symbols as unconscious/conscious projections onto ‘reality’ (where ‘reality’ = the region of causal/acausal. mergence) – as ‘gates’/nexions to the acausal itself, with the seven spheres of the Tree of Wyrd being a ‘map’ of these gates understandable by ‘non–Adept’ consciousness. Thus, the sphere of Mercury re-presents Lucifer/Satan – Mercury, Mars and Sun being the ‘male’ spheres, and Moon, Venus, Jupiter the ‘female’ ones (Saturn being beyond such opposites – ‘Chaos’ itself). The ‘cult of Baphomet’ was the worship of the dark aspect of the ‘female’ energies – where in this context, worship] means a striving toward understanding/conscious integration.

Traces of the worship of the ‘light’ aspect survive in the septenary tradition in the name ‘Aktlal Maka’ (qv notes on Names and Symbols) and the natural form of the Nine Angles rite. The darker aspect survives, in essence, in the Ceremony of Recalling and the traditions associated with the ‘Mistress of Earth’ and ‘Baphomet’. As to the original name of the goddess] in both her aspects, there is a tradition which gives ‘Darkat’ as the name used before ‘Baphomet’ became the common usage. However, ‘Azanigin’ has also been suggested – as has ‘Aktlal–Maka’ for

the 'light'/Gaia aspect, although both these are merely 20th century (ev) suggestions, not based on any oral tradition. Some aspects of the cult of the (dark) goddess are said to have survived into Greek times in the 'Mystery cults' (qv Kabeiroi –and also 'Eleusis' for the 'light' aspect), this being an 'indirect' survival', the 'modern' septenary tradition being a direct one, from Albion. The use of the name 'Baphomet' probably derives from the 10th or 11th century (ev) although the traditional pictorial representation of 'Baphomet' is undoubtedly much older. As elsewhere, if there was an oral tradition connected with the—origin of the name Baphomet, it has been lost. Thus, there are no indications as to the 'original' names of the 'light' and 'sinister' elements on the 'male' side known to us as 'Lucifer' and 'Satan'.

These latter names probably also derive from around the 10th or 11th century (ev) although 'Karu Samsu' (or something very similiar) has been suggested for the 'Lucifer' aspect and 'Sapanur' as the 'sinister' aspect.

The rites associated with the first type of offer such as "The Sinister Calling—cannot be either dated with certainty or seen to be derived from an earlier tradition. In all probability, they derive from the 12th or 13th century (ev) – although it is quite possible that earlier versions/forms existed. Some have even considered The Sinister Calling as a later version of the Ceremony of Recalling. Again, if there was an oral tradition, it has been lost—all that remains are the rituals themselves. The 'Black Mass' itself (and indeed most of the ceremonial rituals in *The Black Book*) probably originated around the same time as The Sinister Calling. The original Mass was said in Latin, although by the middle of the 20th century (ev) a translated version had found its way into the 'Black Book' of necessity, although some Latin chants remained.

O.N.A.

THE SEVEN FOLD WAY: TRAINING AND GRADES

In many ways the seven-fold way can be regarded as a process, by the individual, of discovery and experience. The goal of this process is the production of individuals skilled and knowledgeable in the magickal arts who have developed their latent, occult faculties and who possess the beginnings of wisdom.

This process can result, sometimes by accident over extended periods of time (for example, three decades or more) but it is most usually undertaken as a result of a conscious decision by an individual to seek esoteric and/or magickal groups/Order/Adepts. In this later case – and provided the guidance received is good the goal can be achieved in a much shorter time.

The first part of the process is in many ways the easiest: that of seeking some form of Initiation (qv. the Order MS ‘A Novices Guide to Initiation.’). Before and after Initiation the novice is required to undertake various tasks by the Master or Mistress who has agreed to guide the individual along the seven-fold way. The pre-Initiation tasks are the performance by the individual of a simple hermetic ritual (usually on the night of the full moon), the construction of the simplified version of the Star Game and the successful completion of the various tests aimed at proving the serious intent and commitment of the candidate. The important thing about these tests of intent is that the candidate is unaware of them – for example, the candidate is asked to be present at a certain time and place and instead of meeting there the expected Master or Mistress meets a person of odd appearance who propounds various views which the individual in question may find not only unusual but distasteful. Such tests and encounters are not games but merely devices which enable the candidate to begin to understand their own motives and expectations and as such are an important preparation to Initiation. It is to be understood that it is not the order, which tests the candidate –but the candidates themselves. Initiation is the beginning of the breaking of the illusion of roles, and to be successful this breaking must be done by the individual, from within.

Once this breaking down begins, then Initiation is already underway, and no 'Rite of Initiation' however complex or well-meaning is a substitute for this change in the individual. Such a rite, as a ceremonial ritual, is only the representation of this process in a dramatic form and in many cases is not necessary if some other form of Initiation is more suited to the candidate.

Besides this breaking of self-delusion, Initiation is an awakening of the occult faculties – that is, the experience by the candidate of the reality of magickal forces. This experience can be brought about in several ways – first, by means of a powerful ritual of Initiation which produces magickal forces through invocation; second, through the candidate experiencing the charisma of a Master or Mistress; and third, as a consequence of the individual undergoing a particular experience where magickal forces are present. An example of this third type is when a candidate, expecting perhaps (as a result of their own imagination) a ceremonial ritual of Initiation, is led to an isolated spot where magickal energies are present either naturally (as for example in most stone circles) or have been created beforehand by an Adept in readiness for the candidate. The candidate is then left alone. What the candidate then experiences (sometimes for many hours) is an Initiation – although this is seldom understood by the candidate at the time because outwards form is lacking. In many respects, this third type is the most valuable of all the forms of Initiation since it does not rely on the illusion of ceremonial, or the dogma normally associated with such ritual forms. Initiation is complete when the candidate realizes that a process of inner change has begun.

The next stage of the seven-fold way, following Initiation, is when the novice begins to undertake in a systematic way workings with the various magickal forces through such forms as Path Workings, hermetic and ceremonial rituals. Such workings in themselves take several months and during this time the novice will be given several tasks –some practical, some magickal – to perform. These tasks may themselves take several months to complete. The most usual magickal task involved the novice assuming the 'role' of a dark sorcerer/ sorceress for example, dressing in

black and cultivating a satanic appearance – and in this guise attending various Occult functions and generally trying to provoke argument and dissent. The novice in this is advised to cultivate an attitude of arrogance and pride and must be prepared to defend forcefully their Satanic views. Following this, the novice is expected to infiltrate another magickal group/Order with the intent of attending a ritual and during that ritual either redirecting the magickal power (if any) or invoking by their own effort during the ritual a powerful force of their own choosing to disrupt or otherwise alter the original ritual. In some cases, the novice may organize their own group (recruiting people for it) for just this purpose.

This magickal task develops not only the use of magickal forces in an interesting way but also provides the novice with a goal the attainment of which is invigorating.

It also provides an opportunity for the novice to develop various skills pertaining to the manipulation of other individuals chiefly through the deliberate development of a ‘charismatic’ personality or role. It is the fundamental task of the novice to learn from those experiences – that is, not to allow the role to become dominant.

This is achieved by the novice remembering that they are involved in a seven-fold quest and accepting the advice given by the Master or Mistress who assigned the task. Both of these things some novices find difficult to do. The behavior of the novice during this task is governed by specific guidelines – failure to observe the guidelines by an individual means the end of their noviciate as far as the Order is concerned.

The practical tasks associated with this stage usually involve the novice developing certain physical abilities suited to their character. Such physical goals (for example, cycling 100 miles in under 5 hours or running 20 miles in 2 hours 30 minutes – fitter individuals will be given a more demanding goal) are a necessary balance to the magickal tasks as well as enabling those tasks to be achieved in a more invigorating manner.

This stage generally takes from six months to two years and is concluded when the novice finds changes of perspective arising as a consequence of the self-understanding brought through following the goals and tasks. This change should arise naturally and it is made

conscious to the novice toward the end of the stage through the grade ritual of External Adept. This ritual is a prelude to the goals and tasks of the next stage and signifies the beginning of Adeptship.

The Grade Ritual involves the individual constructing a septenary Star game and the performance by the individual of a certain ritual on a night of the new moon. This ritual involves the invoking of a certain force, female in aspect.

The External Adept may choose to continue with the group or temple begun in the previous stage (or create one if this was not done before) for the purpose of conducting ceremonial and hermetic rituals of the type associated with, for example, the 'Book of Wyrð' as well as for the performance of the chthonic Nine Angles rite if desired. Alternatively, the individual may opt to concentrate on magickal working with the Star Game – and for this (as the task above) a companion is required.

It is a task of the External Adept to find such a companion, as well as to teach them all they themselves have learned during the previous stages – guiding them as they themselves have been guided.

This in itself generally takes from one to two years, and because of this most External Adepts prefer, during this time, to organize a magickal group/Temple since it provides a structure and a focus.

During this stage the External Adept will experience many things, particularly of a magickal kind if rituals are undertaken by a group, and contact with the Master or Mistress will be limited and occur for the most part if the External Adept wishes. It is important during the long period associated with this particular stage, that the individual does not become prey to the illusion of being a Master or Mistress.

Most will of course succumb at some time to this as a consequence of the varied magickal experiences and contacts with those less experienced in magick, many individual sever their links with the Order as a consequence of this illusion.

In some ways this stage is the most difficult, involving as it does confrontation with various roles and what had been called the 'anima/animus', this latter occurring naturally through the training of a companion. Provided the individual maintains during the stage their

resolve to follow to its end the sevenfold way (and here the advice from the Master or Mistress is often crucial at some point during this stage) then, with the completion of the Ritual of the fifth stage, the new Master or Mistress assumes a teaching role via an Order or an individual basis, and usually those who attain this stage take over at some time their Order, guiding individuals along the seven-fold way. They may also create their own Order or group should they so wish, or re, activate the Temple they organized during their time as an External Adept, since the Grade Ritual of Internal Adept by its nature, means the individual must disband such a Temple or leave it in care of one less experienced.

After some years teaching, the Master or Mistress may withdraw to seek the next stage – provided they have trained at least one person to continue the tradition of the seven-fold way. Thus it will be seen that the sevenfold way is not easy. It is a way of life, which any individual may follow. Those who only follow its early stages gain something of benefit, those who go further may achieve the goal that awaits us all: the next stage of human evolution.

In the past, in anyone decade, the Order had many hundreds of candidates seeking Initiation. About four or five a year, sometimes less, may become Initiates through their own choice. Of these, perhaps two will complete the noviciate and only two or three from twenty a decade become Internal Adepts, the others drifting away for various reasons.

Every twenty years, a new Master or Mistress may take office. There may be one or two Magi a century. So it has been –and so it will probably unfortunately remain until the New Aeon be, gins to emerge on the practical level three to four centuries in the future.

The seven-fold way possesses the potential to create (given good guidance) in ten years what it has taken seven civilizations, five Aeons or nearly ten thousand years to achieve. Every individual is free to choose between this path to the divine and a continuation of the sleep that keeps the potentiality of life at bay. All magick is a glimpse of this path – it is up to the individual to walk along it.

ONA, 1988 ch

DARK PATHWORKINGS

One of the initial tasks along the Sinister Path is the Magickal technique known commonly as Pathworking. Essentially this technique is a fundamental to the beginnings of Magickal development.

When working with the Sinister Tarot the Initiate may notice that some workings are far more intense than others. Combined with this intensity is the feeling that the characters and scenery within the image have actually come to life themselves. That is, they suddenly have a life of their own, a life that is no longer restricted by the consciousness of the individual, but suddenly becomes distinctive and objective from that consciousness. It is within these deeper forms of Pathworking that genuine Initiation begins to take place, for it should be noted that the Rite of Initiation does not always bring a complete transformation, but rather is only a beginning.

Two forms of Pathworking can generally be distinguished by the degree of control that the Sinister Pathworker has over the energies/images. In a lesser form of Pathworking the direction of the energies is controlled purely by the individuals imagination, that is for example, the Initiate visualizes the Moon Goddess, imagining that she begins to talk, perhaps in a strange and deep ethereal voice, one that is imbued with the acausal nature of the Being She symbolizes, but which many believe to be purely a dead hunk of rock...

The working here is directed purely by ones imagination. However a deeper state of Pathworking, one which usually only comes when the Initiate has been continually working with the images themselves, is when the Beings within the Cards themselves become alive and imbued, not with the energy of the individuals imagination, for this is itself only a means to work with the energies, but rather, become alive of themselves expressing Their own nature and energy, that which is both within and without, that which is the acausal.

Another aspect of this degree of difference between the objective and subjective status of the Being with which the Dark Tradition works is expressed in the Dark Pathways themselves. These workings further the

initial descent into the acausal, one which may itself be tentative and misunderstood.

As is stated in other Order MSS, it is by practical experience that the Sinister Initiate discerns the status of the Dark Gods themselves and this can never really be passed on in writings. For it is often believed that the writings of others can bring wisdom and enlightenment by themselves, yet this also is an illusion of the Abyss.

It is quite correct to assume that the writings of others may help to guide, but, as has been stated many times before, they are only a guide, not a substitute. It is only through direct personal Invocation that the Dark Gods can be understood.

During the Dark Pathways the Magickian meditates upon the corresponding Tarot image, allowing the energies summoned to manifest as it will in accordance with the symbolism. However, if a working is truly successful the imagery of the card will serve its purpose by providing a gateway, or perhaps more accurately a vehicle through which the specific Dark God may manifest its Being. Thus working with Atazoth, the Master card itself is soon lost in the vortical Chaos that is emitted from the pictorial representation of the Man of the Abyss. Atazoth then fills the Initiates mind, revealing his being to be far more alien than that of a mere humanoid.

As an expansion upon the existing Dark Pathways techniques I suggest the following working:

Dark Pathways II

- **Requirements: Black Robe**
- **Quartz crystal**
- **Sinister Tarot Atu.**

- Decide upon a mode of dress. Usually this will be one of three: Black robe, naked, or dressed in black.

- Arriving at the area near or after sunset, prepare your clothing and set out the implements.

- Chant the respective sphere chant facing East and holding the crystal at chest height.

- Now vibrate the Sacred Word nine times. If a chant is required then chant this instead, but if this is not known then vibrate the name nine times then another four times.

- Place the crystal in a secure position and begin the slow dance, the direction of which you may decide yourself (usually Deosil for lighter spheres and Widdershin for darker spheres, i.e. Mars and Jupiter would be Widdershins).

- Speed the dance up faster and faster until you fall to the ground. Now vibrate or shout the name as strongly as possible.

- After a moment, visualise the Tarot image, do not attempt to control or direct the visions though, let them come and go as they do.

- Once the visions pass, stand and then begin a dance in the opposite direction to the original dance. Singing/chanting 'I am the Power, I am the Glory, I am a God.'

- When satisfied, cease your dance. Then face bow to the North saying: 'It is completed.'

- Leave the area of the working.

Additional Notes: Prior to the ritual for seven days meditate upon the sigil of the Dark God to be invoked for at least fifteen minutes each night prior to sleep, quietly repeating its name. If possible follow the recommended Black Fast. The location of a suitable area for working is also essential. An isolated wood is ideal, though geographical variations may determine alternative locations. The addition of the Sphere chant at the beginning of the Rite seems to open the Gate to the acausal wider thereby enabling the Dark God/Energy to manifest in a far stronger manner.

Try and use the dance to express the sphere/planet itself. It may be helpful to consider the astronomical/astrological significances of the planet, such as the size, its speed around the Sun and so on. These may

give clues to the planets energies and thereby by expressed during the dance itself.

Essentially the Dark Pathways should be experienced by the Initiate him or herself in order for the individual to devise the technique that works best for him/her. However, although the main body of the Ritual should stay essentially the same, it is quite natural that the individual will find variations that work better for him/her, such as the manner of the dance itself for example.

Lyceus (1999 ch.)

DARK PATHWORKINGS II

A successful completion of all the Dark Pathways leaves the Sinister Initiate with a feeling of exaltation and pride based on the knowledge that one has completed one stage of the Great Work. There is a greater belief in oneself and a development of individual Will. Yet there should also be an honest self-examination of the past 6 months. The Initiate should honestly evaluate the overall degree of success of the workings. If a particular working was not successful why was this? Was the Initiates mind fully on the working itself? Or were other events in the Initiates life, events perhaps outside of the Initiates involvement in the Tradition that were causing disruption? All of this must be analysed so that the Initiate can begin to see what factors combined to create a successful working and what factors worked against this success.

For a working to be successful the visions or astral experiences of the Initiate will have a strong effect upon the Initiates consciousness. Astral projection to a lesser or greater degree may occur (but this is also dependent upon the extent of the relaxation of the Initiates body). The contact with archetypal forms will also be spontaneous, that is, the characters met within the working will seem to have a volition and consciousness of their own, there is not, in a genuine working an apparent manipulation of the astral forms by the Initiates consciousness, rather these forms appear overtly as distinct from the Initiates consciousness. The working will then leave the Initiate with a feeling of loss when he or she returns to the mundane world.

Immediately it can be seen that there is a differing degree of intensity between a successful and unsuccessful working, with the latter requiring the Initiate to try and make the astral characters speak to him or her. This latter form of working tends to leave the Initiate with a feeling that he is simply talking to himself, whilst the former leaves a quite different feeling not only of success and therefore elation, but one that also enhances the Initiates connection with the Dark Gods Themselves. It should not need to be stated that one of the aims of the Stages of Initiate and External Adept is to hone the success rate of Magickal Ritual to a fine degree.

But, whatever descriptions are applied to Sinister Ritual these will always unfortunately be inadequate because Sinister Ritual taps the emotional energy of the participants and such energy can never be expressed in words.

Another factor that plays heavily upon the working is the location for the working itself. The isolated hilltop or wood are usually the best outdoor locations but are not necessarily easy to find and the (unconscious) fear of intrusion upon the working can actually impede the working itself to such an extent that it may suffer accordingly. For this reason it may be more suitable to undertake the working indoors in a room set aside as a Sinister Temple or in a part of a room if individual circumstances cannot provide a separate Temple. However with this said, outdoor workings do add to the overall working and the effects of such isolated locations can be quite considerable where such an isolated location can (and should) add to the intensity of the ritual itself, it being ideal if the Initiate can undertake a reasonably long walk bereft of artificial light to the chosen site prior to the ritual.

If such a location cannot be found then another solution presents itself whereby the Sinister Initiate should move to an area of the country that can provide an isolated wilderness wherein he or she can continue to follow the Seven-Fold Sinister Way without attracting too much attention. Of course such a move depends greatly upon the Initiates involvement with Tradition and desire to follow the Way to completion.

However, one should note that although the intensity of the actual working may be impeded by the possible proximity of intruders/non-initiates, this reason alone should not prevent the workings to be undertaken to some extent out doors in a reasonably isolated location.

The actual time-scale of the Dark Pathway Rituals are not – as many may misunderstand – one per week, rather it is for a continuous period of 21 weeks. For the Dark Pathway Rituals should not be perceived as individual and separate from one another, but rather, combine to create an organic whole {and this is true of the whole of the Septenary System itself}. Thus, the Initiate is undertaking one single ritual that is broken down into 21 smaller rituals. This single ritual provides an insight into the

reality of Adepthood, a reality that reveals a long and slow process of alchemical change.

Lyceus, ONA 1999 eh

PATHWORKING II: A BRIEF EXAMPLE

Introduction

As stated in previous Order MSS. the Initiate is expected to complete successively all Dark Pathways prior to undertaking the Sphere-workings, which will last until the undertaking of the Rite of External Adept. The following diary extract is provided to enable a glimpse into the practice of modern Hermetic Satanism on an individual level.

Sphere-Workings – 25th December 1998

Moon Sphere

Moon – Deofel – Death

I began the working with the continual repetition of the vibration of the word of power *Nōx*. As I did so I held my hands over my quartz rock crystal.

Following this I chanted the *Agios Kabeiri* and then began the second and final vibration, accompanied by the visualisation of the sphere sigil, as given in *Naos*. Essentially all my visions were spontaneous and I feel that they were essentially more genuine and thus of themselves rather than imaginary/false.

As I vibrated *Nōx*, I was standing at the large oak door of a cave. The door slowly opened as I vibrated the word of power. As the door opened the figure of the Moon Goddess appeared beyond. She stood looking at me in silence in the darkness. Then she turned and without a word walked deeper into the darkness of the caves interior. I followed her noticing that she illuminated the surrounding cave walls as she slowly made her way deeper into the Earth. Eventually, within a fairly short space of time she led me out into another world. A large Moon hung low against the sky of night yet I saw no other stars or planets. Beneath us, a heavy sea raged in perpetual motion, as though overtly intimating a strong connection to the passing of Time and as I looked seawards I wondered what ships might be distantly sailing upon the heavy waves or what strange creatures might be swimming beneath its surface. Truly archetypal I thought. And not

once did she speak to me, but remained silent as though in a speechless communion with the surrounding Nature and low grey scarred Moon. There was no need for words, they would just hinder this understanding I realised.

Behind us a huge wall of rock veered upwards. As my eyes followed its height, I saw the ghost of an old and hideous looking house that had once stood upon its summit. I looked upwards the sky suddenly lit up as a jagged lightning bolt struck the ghost-house. A steady downpour began and I looked back at the Goddess who remained motionless, Her silent communion seemingly undisturbed by the onset of rain.

Before me a new vision began to appear, as though a new sphere of existence had suddenly lowered itself to the sphere I was now on. At first a Path of Water, appearing icy and cold, then a wood, waterlogged but surrounding the original Path. This too changed until I began to see firm ground, patches of green and brown, decaying leaves, twigs and branches that lay discarded under a cold blanket of snow.

I began forwards, then upwards as the Path led me from the first sphere into a new and yet also disturbing world. Then, the first vision. The beast so black in fur, its eyes black then red. The beast from Little Red Riding Hood lived in this world and I knew that this spiritual encounter would be far removed from a Nazarene influenced fairy tale. I began to run after him. His pace swift as he deftly passed through the undergrowth. As I ran I tried to commune with the beast, to understand him on his level not mine. A level that lay beyond the images and false ideas projected by the unconscious human and that only served to cage the animal in a false reality. Thoughts aplenty came forth. How many times I had seen the animals both wild and tamed and it always seemed that I could never truly commune with them because my naturalness had been bred out of me, because all around me people had tried, albeit unconsciously, to keep me away from the imaginary fears and loathings they held towards their true saviour and kin: the Nature Goddess and her children. I was no hunter in this world, nor was there any hunted. Rather [I wished] to commune with that totem spirit that had at last appeared to me. The power of the Wolf calling me onwards, deeper and deeper into

that cold and human-less wilderness. Until, I fell into the circle, an openness deep within the cold dusk-laden wood.

The pack and its leader surrounded me as I lay upon the ground my back to the earth, my face to the stars, and yet, there were no stars here. Only the hideous howl that issued forth from the Pack leader – that beast, that Deofel. Then they were upon me, snarling and clawing and biting and ripping the flesh from my soon-to-be corpse.

Within seconds, the supernatural beasts had feasted upon my flesh and bone leaving only bright red blood and shiny blood stained bones, my ribcage remained intact, so also my skull, all else had been taken as I gladly paid my overdue troth to my totem animal, a gift of spiritual sacrifice. As I lay there conscious that I no longer had a flesh-body she appeared to me. Was this Hekate? Returned from the long dead past? Or Morrighan? Budsturga? Cat Anna? I looked upon Her radiant beauty as she smiled hovering above the ground, a white aura silhouetting her shape. Then she was gone and the unearthly howls of the Wolf-pack began to fade and I awoke in a place: a chamber wherein a wise and cunning beast was Lord.

At first the figure remained motionless. Here I felt that I was able to move more easily, my corpse having been left with the Deofel and his Pack. The Sphinx left the pedestal and began to walk around the room, confident that I would not attempt to pass through the Gate. She began to preen herself, her snake-like tongue flicking momentarily as she spoke. “You can move around easier without your body.” She said, I remained silent. ‘Are you going to ask me a riddle?’ I asked.

“You are the riddle.” She replied. “The human is the riddle.” She walked slowly around the room, I floated over to the opening, but with no intention of passing through until I had been granted permission.

‘Look,’ she said indicating to the darkness of the Cosmos, ‘There is the riddle. You are that. What else could be more important than the realization that you are one with that?’ Again I remained silent listening to her words.

‘You do not even exist, that is all there has been, that is all there is, and that is all there will be.’ I saw flashes of my destiny, understood more about the Great Work, why I was where I was and how important our

work was. I could see the possibility of a future Man of Destiny. A Man of the Cosmos. He who would restore the Pagan Warrior ethos and thereby insure Wyrð was achieved.

‘You may pass through,’ The sphinx said as I stood looking into the room, my back to the opening. I sensed that I began to fall backwards, until I was falling into the emptiness. I saw the star above me and knew that it was not a journey I would be taking this time. As I fell I began to sense a unity with that emptiness and then all was nothing...

It is easy to write off Pathworking as simply fantasy or ‘imagination’. Such discarding of one of the oldest shamanic practices of Europe is frankly rather ridiculous.

Not only does such an opinion have no basis in fact, it also proves that such an individual has never undertaken to follow an occult way for a length of time. Or perhaps such an individual began a Path for a day or two, didn’t achieve any results and so decided it was all nonsense. Of course such individuals will never achieve anything significant because they are unable to maintain the discipline required for genuine Initiation. Pathworkings will only begin to come alive after a period of time. It is useless to expect results immediately. This is like the impatient child wanting everything straight away. Perseverance is one of the keys to successful Pathworking, but there is more besides and this bears repeating because it is very important if a successful outcome of Pathworking is sought.

There needs to be an invocation and direction of energy to begin with so that the archetypes become enlivened with acausal energy. If there is little or no energy raised then there will only be imagination. A chief factor in this might be due to the chosen location. If a chosen location is not adequately isolated –there being a strong chance of interruption –then a different location should be found less this adversely affects the workings. After 6 months of continued Pathworking the acausal Gate within the Initiate will begin to open, some may achieve greater degrees of success such as astral projection and foresight, whilst others may only have brief almost momentary experiences. The astral body should become stronger and there will be a growing belief in oneself and one’s abilities, which will

enhance as the individual moves deeper into the Abyss. The work is simple and effective, it is proved to work by those who have followed it in their individual ways. All is needed is determination.

Lyceus, ONA.

SHUGARA – A SINISTER PATHWORKING

I have just returned from that specially chosen site in the forest, just three miles from here. This time, I had been successful in allowing myself to become more thoroughly immersed into, and absorbed with, the spirit of the place, and the Invocation itself. As for the previous Pathworkings, there had always been a kind of foreboding, a certain hesitation, a tangible fear and recognition that this communion with primal Nature, under the dark, open sky, all alone, was overwhelming – beyond the romanticized, dualistic perception of Nature and the Cosmos so prevalent within modern-day paganism and new-age thinking.

Today, however, all such hesitation and fear – separateness – dissolved. A manifest connexion has been created on this cold, early Winter morning. All distractions, all strange, hidden surroundings united with my Being. I had successfully confronted the fear, which once, when I was unaware, had controlled and limited the promise that is my Life; that primal fear of the Dark – that Shadow which threatens to emerge into this causal existence and devour. Today, I have faced this fear.

The walk to the chosen site was a brisk one, as I was forced to travel up the hillside in a long, winding manner, as necessitated by the steep cliffs of the hillside. Every step was made in deliberation and contemplation, knowing that this was an exercise of Will, in unison with Nature's higher order, a discovery of the Primal Darkness within and without. I was aware that this Darkness, this Shadow was about to be confronted.

Unlike before, I instinctively understood that on this morning, I would travel through the forest without aid of flashlight or lantern. There existed simply an instinctive knowing –that this was necessary, that there could be no crutches, no hesitation, no turning back. This newly added element, together with the fact that coyotes are well known to roam and hunt along these parts, functioned to make this Pathworking, this brief moment in a life-long Quest, all the more interesting –all the more worthwhile.

Finally, after traveling through the heavily forested area, I entered into the small, flat circular clearing, which I had gone to some pains to locate

some weeks earlier. I knew when I first came to this place, with its solitary, circular formation of trees in the center, that this clearing was indeed fated for such a venture. Here, one was surrounded by both the awe-inspiring presence of Nature, in the raw, and by the stark, intimidating vastness of the heavens.

Here, there could be no simple pandering to the ego in some urbanized, disrespectful form of sorcery so prevalent within the city. One was within Nature's grasp, with only three choices: 1) to bow down to Her in some feeble attempt to show respect; 2) to disrespect Her by ignoring Her, and by investing one's energy into the petty purpose of building one's own ego; or 3) to become One with Her – what, in fact, She truly desires.

After unloading the relevant supplies from my backpack, I first lit the charcoal I had packed, and placed on top of it the incense I had prepared – a mixture representing the combination of the energies attributed to Luna (the sphere of hidden knowledge) and Mars (the sphere of sacrifice, death and destruction). Afterwards, I lit the candles, one red, the other blue, and stood quietly, understanding that this exercise was more than a mere mindless, egotistic abstraction. This was the continuation of a sequential Becoming, of a living, breathing entity possessing the potential to alchemically transform. This Calling was a step further in that process of stripping away the deceptive, temporal layer to reveal what is, and to progressively become One with that essence. Yes, I had understood that this was in fact a sequential unfolding of the genuine Dark Tradition.

After several moments, I began visualizing the sigil of Shugara, the Dark God-related entity associated with the fourth Pathway of the Dark Tradition. And, as I visualized this sigil, I began the first of thirteen deep vibrations, nine in continuous succession, then a short pause, and four more vibrations. The deep, resonant quality of these vibrations was revealing a remarkable improvement from previous attempts. The entire week previous had been spent preparing for this event. A steady decrease of food, meat and sleep had been implemented one week prior to this morning, with the last day providing very little food or sleep for this morning. At this moment, I could feel the positive effects produced by

such a preparation, as the vibrant, resonant energy emanating from my solar plexus began rising and spreading throughout the whole of my body. This tangible energy was reverberating within my uttermost Being; an energy which, had I not taken the previous week to prepare for, I'd have been numb toward.

An altered state of consciousness was rapidly manifesting. It felt as though it were my very own spirit producing the sound. A tangible oneness had begun to travel like an electric current pulsating through my Being – a concrete partaking of energies that were at once both personal and supra-personal, unconscious and Cosmic.

It seemed as though I had 'plugged in' to an entirely new source of energy. Indeed, by the fourth or fifth repetition, my vibrations began to grow not only in strength and power, but in duration as well. A good fifteen to twenty seconds was elapsing before my breath and power gave out, requiring a new breath to be drawn. Yes, something inside was awakening, a Chthonic Darkness millennia old, yet so vibrantly and enticingly new.

Now, I finished the thirteenth and final vibration, my voice echoing in the dark, intimidating silence. With my Will vocalized, I reclined across the cold ground, closing my eyes and breathing deeply, waiting for this new energy to manifest. At this point, while realizing I was confronting that Darkness which threatens to devour, I could sense a literal hair-raising fear, a fear which seemed to be sensed by the forest itself.

At first, what I witnessed was a violent eruption of dark, black smoke mushrooming forth out of a deep well. I knew at once that this signified the awakening and unleashing of the Shadow within. The Dark was being presented...

What then followed was both enlightening and unsettling. It seemed as though I was able to leave my body and travel directly overhead. I could see the area of the forest which directly surrounded me. What this panoramic view revealed was rather disconcerting: in a perfect circle, surrounding me on every side, were a pack of wolves, crouched down and hidden by the surrounding brush, visibly positioned to pounce at any given moment. What I immediately found to be even more alarming, was

the simple fact that each wolf was perfectly still – there was no sound, no sign of restlessness, no apparent agitation or warning of any kind. Not once did I hear them approach. Nevertheless, they were there, and my own prior lack of empathy and self-awareness became startling clear.

These ‘wolves’ represented, for me, that which threatens to devour, and that which most likely will devour if not confronted, explored and resolved. The fact that I could now see these ‘wolves’ revealed that I was indeed now beginning to develop a real empathy with my true self and with the primal essence of Nature.

The genuine Sinister Tradition had afforded for me the opportunity to transcend these primal fears which had earlier held sway over my Being. This Tradition had provided me with the raw materials for surpassing present consciousness – a surpassing which alone is able to provide one with a clear and precise evaluation of one’s true self.

After what seemed a long time, new images began to appear, most notably those which had been invading my dreams, or rather nightmares, ever since I had been initiated into the Dark Tradition some weeks earlier. These strange dreams had contained very bizarre images, and had even occasionally become somewhat disruptive. It was as though distant, faded objects, from a past that I was minutely aware of, began invading my consciousness, though I knew perfectly well that it was all in accordance with my own Will. I was more consciously aware now than at any other moment that my Initiation had in fact opened a Gate within my psyche, that this was in fact a genuine occurrence beyond mere delusion, and that the Shadow is indeed a factual fragment of the Self, lying dormant, awaiting the opportunity to be developed and integrated, so as to create a new, evolved, un-divided Being.

The most startling image, which appeared at that moment, was (and had been since I first encountered it in a horrific dream just days earlier) an enigma that seemed to haunt at the very edges of consciousness. It appeared as an intimidating black fish, or shark, of very large proportions, silently hovering at the very bottom of the ocean in complete darkness, as though it had remained there for centuries, or even for millennia, forgotten – waiting...

While gazing at this image, it was as I had been transported into that timeless existence in which the Dream itself had originally taken place. This time, I possessed a clarity of understanding, which I had not earlier possessed while in the dream. I found myself plunged once again into the cold, dark, murky depths in which I first encountered the huge Beast. In the original dream, I had, at this point, become frenzied and hurried, struggling to head back up to the water's surface, where I could hope to find some sort of safety. However, now all such desperation was absent – controlled. Rather than struggling to escape the Darkness, I found myself exploring the Darkness. And again, just as in the Dream, I bumped into that impenetrable Darkness, which at first puzzled me, that is, until I saw the Face of that Darkness.

There it was the same giant creature, which, in the Dream, had devoured me. Actually, I had awoken just after the huge creature grunted and immediately lunged toward me with teeth glaring, but I was nevertheless aware that I had been devoured within the Dream, and that this encounter was symbolic of something unknown, yet very real. However, at this precise moment in the replaying of my Dream, I immediately understood the meaning of this fish. I now understood that I was encountering a projected symbol of my undiscovered, unrealized self – the Dark Unconscious; that aspect of the psyche which has been the occasion for many uncontrolled, destructive, frightening bursts of the acausal into the physical world throughout history. I also understood that this Darkness was not only something internal, but external to myself as well.

During this last phase of the Pathworking, I could sense the increase of a tangible euphoria coming over my body. I could truly sense a genuine Becoming taking place, and that this experience was void of any mystification or abstract romanticism. There was present only a steely, sober clarity that what was taking place was genuine, solid step toward Eternity, toward Becoming, and toward Destiny.

As I left the site, a new awareness of, and connexion with, the forest permeated my being. All noise, all abstract thoughts, all nervous mind-activity, so common within the metropolis, was absent. Only a distinct,

unmistakable knowing permeated my consciousness; a knowing which only further clarified, and solidified, Direction. This new insight, this new personal victory, was to be only one of many such victories and events, which, together, allow for a Becoming. Yes, there would many more experiences, which would, over time, become much more varied and certainly more difficult.

Now, the darkness in the forest did not intimidate – it called. Shugara had come, and I was not the same.

Collyn Branwell, ONA.

PART TWO

THE SINISTER TAROT OF CHRISTOS BEEST



1. THE MOON



2. ABYSSUS ABYSSUM INVOCAT



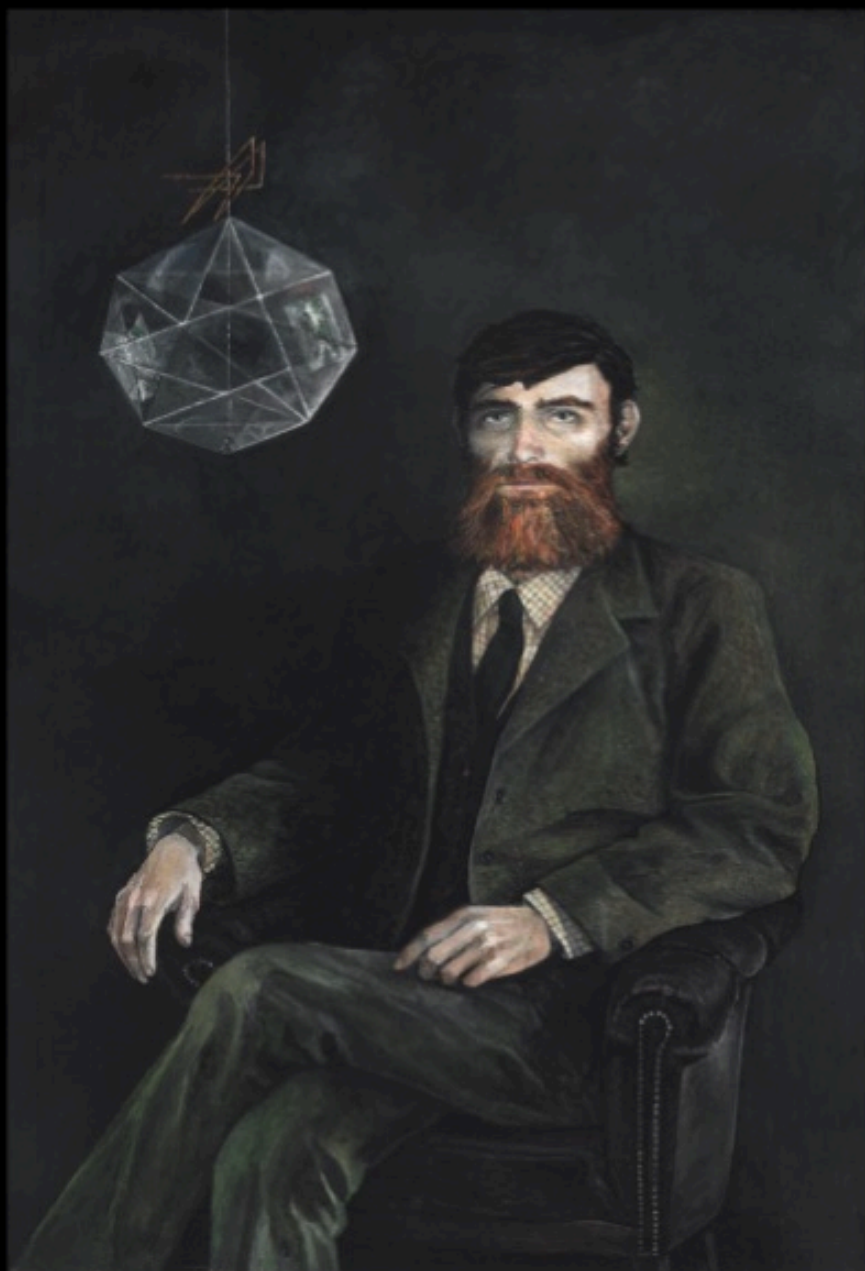
3. AFTER THE RAPTURE



4. THE BIRTH OF THE WORD IN THE HEART



5. THE GREEN DAMASK ROOM



6. IN THE HEART OF THE WOOD
AND WHAT I FOUND THERE



7. XAVIER



8. THE HIDDEN TRACK



9. BANAIS



10. RUBICON



11. THE EXILE'S SONG



12. HYPNOGOGUE



13. WHERE THE SEA ONCE WAS



14. THE NIGHT BEFORE THE
DAWN OF THE TRIBULATION



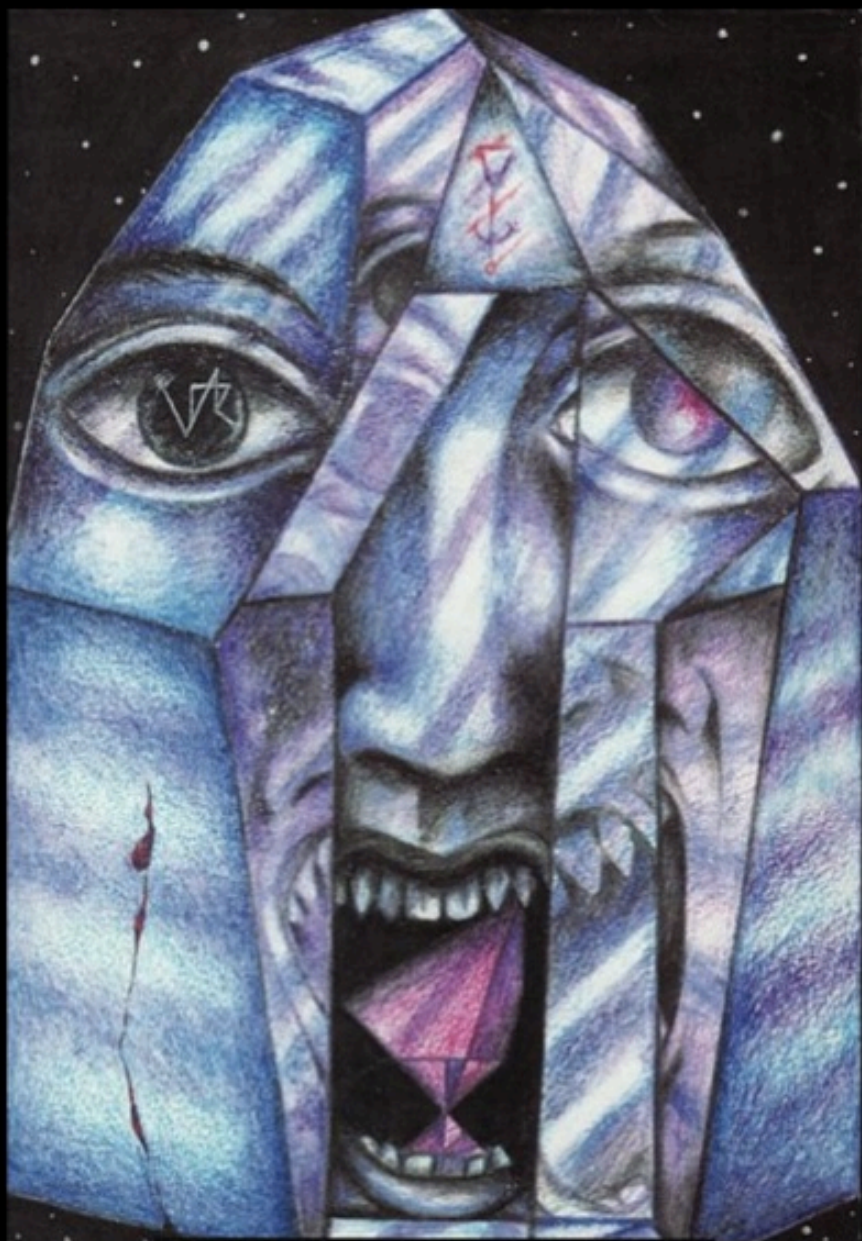
15. SAPPHO III



16. SAPPHO IV



17. WYRD (ALTERNATE VERSION)



18. SAPPHO I



19. SAPPHO II



20. SAPPHO V



21. PHYSIS



22. WARRIOR OF SWORDS (VERSION 2)



23. THE STAR



24. THE HIGH PRIESTESS



25. WARRIOR OF CHALICES



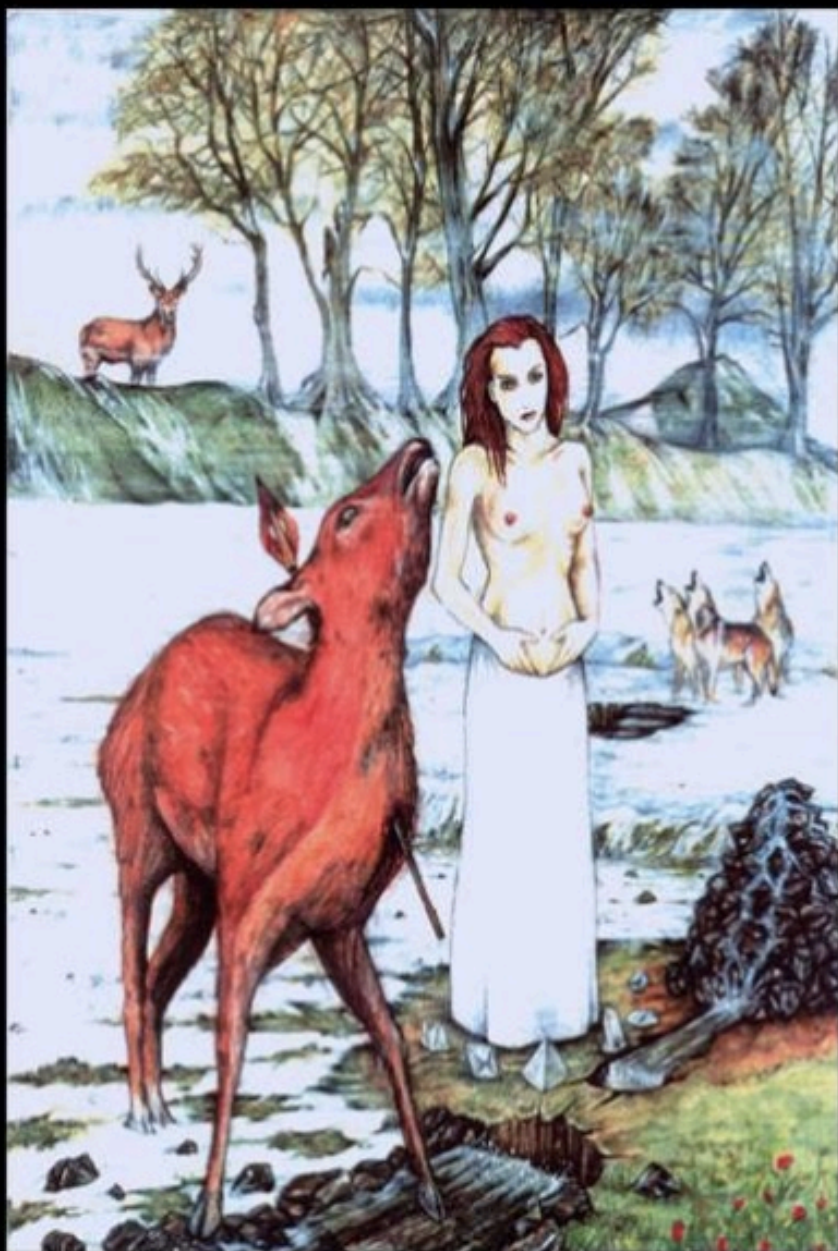
26. MAGUS OF PENTACLES



27. HYPNAGOGUE II



28. MAIDEN OF CHALICES



29. LORD OF THE EARTH



30. MAIDEN OF WANDS



31. DESIRE



32. MAIDEN OF SWORDS



33. MISTRESS OF EARTH



34. THE HERMIT



35. WARRIOR OF PENTACLES



36. TO THE DISTANT ONE



37. MOUSA OF CHALICES



38. HYPNOCOGUE 10



39. THE MAGICKIAN



40. MAGUS OF CHALICES



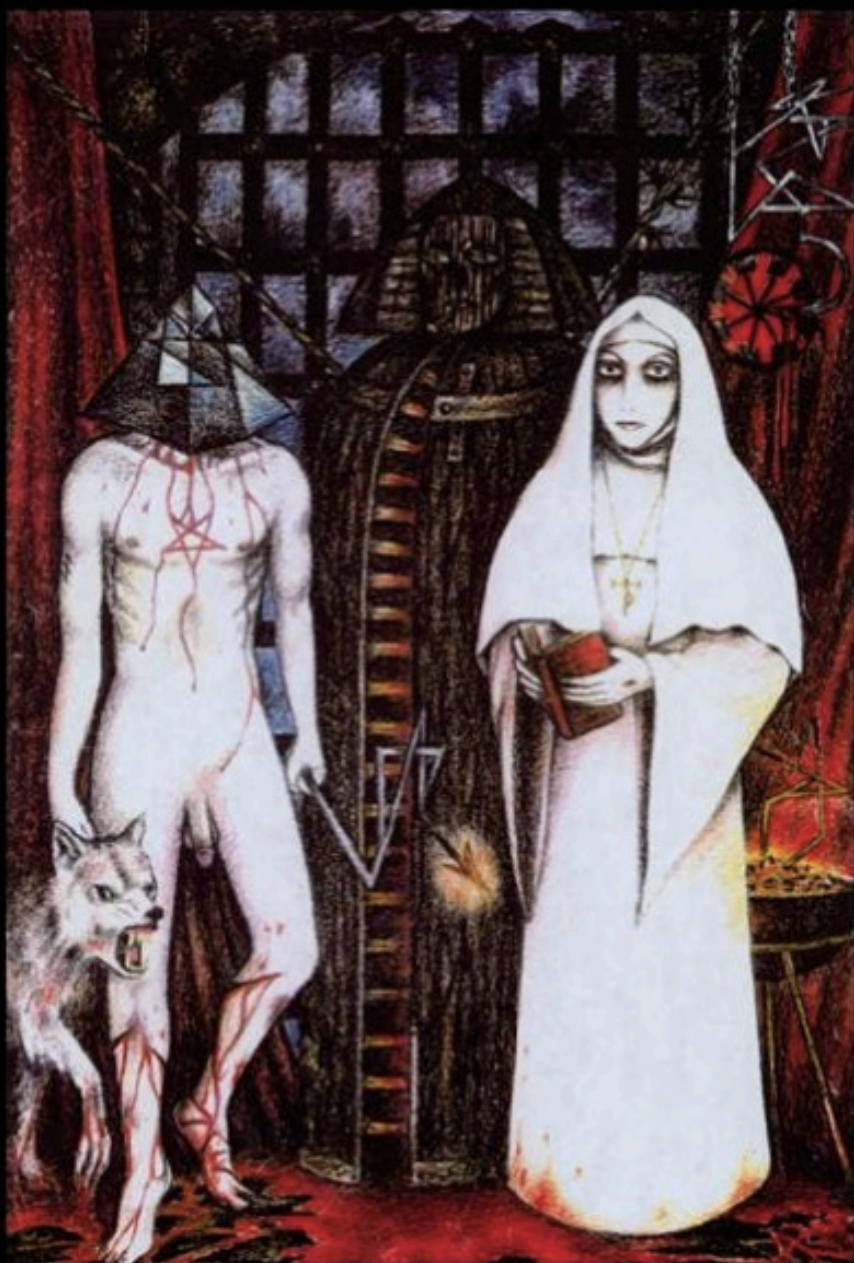
41. MOUSA OF SWORDS



42. MAIDEN OF PENTACLES



43. AZOTH



44. DEOFEL



45. MOUSA OF WANDS



46. THE MASTER



47. END OF A SEASON 1



48. PSALM 42



49. CHANGE



50. OPFER



51. AEON



52. WARRIOR OF SWORDS



53. WARRIOR OF WANDS



54. DEATH



55. THE LOVERS



56. HEL



57. WAR



58. WYRD



59. THE SUN



60. THE MAGICKIAN (ALTERNATE VERSION)



61. TO THE SETTING SUN



62. HYPNAGOGUE 8



63. SALT (HYPNAGOGUE 6)



64. DREAM

